

Malware Indicators of Compromise (IOCs) & APT28

🔧 **Tool Name:** Virus Total & Hybrid Analysis

History:

Virus Total was founded in 2004 and later acquired by Google. It allows users to scan files and URLs for viruses, malware, and other threats. Hybrid Analysis is an online malware analysis platform that provides detailed reports on malware behavior. These tools are widely used by security analysts and forensic investigators to detect malware and gather Indicators of Compromise (IOCs).



Description:

These tools help in identifying malicious files and analyzing malware behavior. They provide detailed IOC data such as IP addresses, domains, file hashes, and URLs associated with malware. This is crucial for threat intelligence, incident response, and forensic investigations.



What Is This Tool About?

- Detect malware in files, URLs, or memory dumps.
- Extract IOCs to trace attack patterns.
- Understand malware behavior and techniques.



Key Characteristics / Features:

- Detects malware using multiple antivirus engines (VirusTotal)
- Provides detailed malware reports (Hybrid Analysis)
- IOC extraction (IP, domains, hashes)
- Sandbox execution to monitor behavior
- Free and paid tiers available
- Generates downloadable reports
- Supports automation via API
- Useful for threat intelligence and incident response



Types / Modules Available:

- File/URL Scanning Module (VirusTotal)
- Behavior Analysis Module (Hybrid Analysis)

- IOC Extraction Module
- Reporting and Logging Module

How Will This Tool Help?

- Identify malicious files and their attributes
- Gather IOCs for investigation and defense
- Analyze malware behavior safely in a sandbox
- Support forensic reporting and threat intelligence

PoC Images (placeholders to add screenshots):

- Terminal output or web scan results of a malware hash in VirusTotal
- Extracted IOCs (IPs, domains, file hashes) in a table
- Hybrid Analysis report screenshot

15-Liner Summary:

- Scans files and URLs for malware
- Detects malicious behaviors
- Extracts Indicators of Compromise
- Sandbox analysis
- Reports with detailed information
- Supports multiple antivirus engines
- Free and paid tiers
- API support for automation
- Generates downloadable logs
- Helps forensic investigations
- Assists in incident response
- Useful for threat intelligence
- Provides malware behavior analysis
- Supports safe execution of suspicious files
- Widely used by cybersecurity professionals

Time to Use / Best Case Scenarios:

- When a suspicious file or URL is detected
- After a malware incident

- During threat intelligence research
- While performing forensic investigations

When to Use During Investigation:

- Post malware infection
- During IOC collection
- Tracing attacker infrastructure
- Identifying malware campaigns like APT28

Best Person to Use & Required Skills:

User: Security Analyst / Forensic Investigator / Threat Intelligence Analyst

Skills:

- Familiarity with malware types
- Basic understanding of network and file IOCs
- Knowledge of sandbox analysis
- Using VirusTotal and Hybrid Analysis

Flaws / Suggestions to Improve:

- Limited free scans on VirusTotal
- Hybrid Analysis may take time to execute samples
- Cannot always analyze encrypted or packed malware
- Some reports may be technical for beginners

Good About the Tool:

- Free and accessible
- Accurate and reliable IOC extraction
- Safe malware analysis
- Widely recognized and used in cybersecurity
- Generates detailed, structured reports